So where do we go from here? Was the Big Bang unique, or just a violent transition point? Will our cosmic existence be dramatically cut short by another universe coming down on us like a higher-dimensional flyswatter? Will data from cosmology or particle physics ever reveal the true nature of spacetime? How close are we to finding out what our cosmic far future holds, and what new information do we need to answer the question, once and for all?

How will it all end?

Like everything in science, our understanding of the cosmos is a perpetual work in progress. But that progress has, over the last few decades, been extraordinary, and new insights are coming fast. Over just the next few years, humanity will gain new tools that will give us an unprecedented view of our cosmic history, allowing us to piece together the story of our origins and open new windows onto the Big Bang, dark matter, dark energy, and our trajectory into the future. In the final chapter of *this* story, we'll get a glimpse of what those new tools might show us, and how work on the cutting edge of physics is already pointing us toward a universe far stranger than we ever could have imagined.